

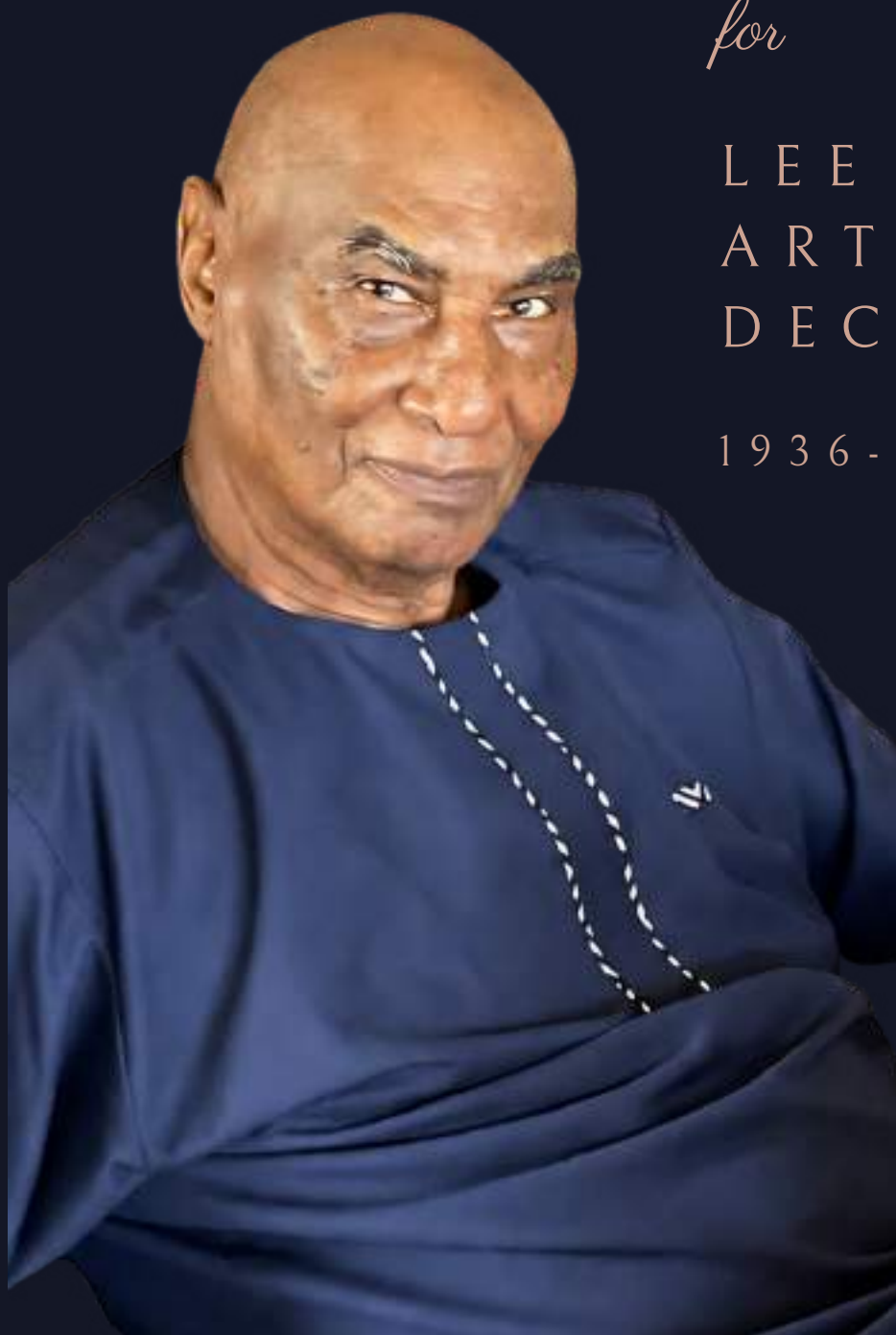
A
CELEBRATION
of Life

for

LEE
ARTHUR
DECUIR

1936 - 2026

In Loving Memory



A MAN OF CHARACTER

LOVE. INTEGRITY, DIGNITY, AND HONOR WERE
THE FOUNDATION OF EVERYTHING HE DID.



“To know Lee was to experience depth, warmth, intellect, and intentional living.”

“Lee did not simply live a life he created a world... A Life... Beautifully Curated Across Five Worlds: Family, Travel, Art, Books & Music”





ORDER OF SERVICE



MASTER OF CEREMONIES: GEORGE
KARAMAGI

OPENING PRAYER

MUSICAL SELECTION

SCRIPTURE READING PSALM 23:4

TRIBUTE OF LOVE — FAMILY

REFLECTIONS FROM THE CHILDREN

REFLECTIONS FROM WIFE, PHILIPPA
DECUIR

LIFE REFLECTIONS — GEORGE
KARAMAGI

SPECIAL TRIBUTE VIDEO PRESENTATION

MUSICAL TRIBUTE

WORDS OF COMFORT — WILLIS LOGAN

CLOSING PRAYER

A Life

BEAUTIFULLY CURATED



Yea, though I walk through the valley of the shadow of death,
I will fear no evil; for Thou art with me; Thy rod and Thy staff
they comfort me.” — Psalm 23:4



With heavy hearts and deep gratitude for a life intentionally and beautifully lived, we celebrate the life of Lee Arthur Decuir, who departed this life on April 14, 2026, at the age of 90, in Houston, Texas.

Lee was born on January 29, 1936, in Shreveport, Louisiana, to Buker Decuir and Elizabeth Crockom. From an early age, he possessed a quiet strength, a curious mind, and a presence that would eventually impact lives across continents.

After attending Venture High School, Lee earned a full basketball scholarship to Pepperdine University, where he was admired not only as an athlete, but also as a leader within the university community. Following graduation, Lee began pursuing a master's degree before destiny redirected his path. After interviewing with TWA Airlines, he was selected as the first Black American Managing Director for the airline's African operations headquarters in Kampala, Uganda, a historic achievement that would forever shape the course of his life.

Africa was not simply a destination for Lee; it became a calling.

Through his travels across continents, from bustling cities to remote corners of the world, Lee developed a profound appreciation for culture, language, history, and humanity. His career with TWA refined his leadership, sharpened his communication skills, and expanded his global perspective. More importantly, it nurtured a lifelong passion for connection, exploration, and purpose.

In 1973, Lee was selected to serve as part of an official United States six-month African tour delegation alongside distinguished leaders, including Mr. Jim Woods. During this extraordinary journey, he had the rare honor of meeting Emperor Haile Selassie of Ethiopia, a moment he cherished for the remainder of his life.

Traveling throughout Africa, Lee immersed himself in the richness of its people, traditions, art, and music.

He collected more than artifacts; he collected stories, experiences, and relationships that became woven into the fabric of his identity.

At the conclusion of the six-month tour, during a New Year's Eve celebration at Kampala's renowned Apollo Hotel, Lee proposed to Philippa, who was then completing her studies at Makerere University.

A year later, they were married in Kampala, Uganda, beginning a beautiful union rooted in love, adventure, and shared purpose.

Soon afterward, they relocated to New York before later returning to Nairobi, Kenya, where Lee established businesses and continued building a life deeply connected to Africa.

It was in Nairobi that Lee and Philippa welcomed their children, Kwame and Lisa, both born at Nairobi Hospital and forever connected to the African story that shaped their family.

In 1984, as their children reached school age, the family returned to the United States. Yet Africa never left Lee's heart. He continued traveling back frequently, maintaining lifelong friendships and deep cultural ties. Even in his later years, Lee planned a return journey to Africa in May 2026, with Rwanda especially close to his heart.

Beyond his travels and accomplishments, Lee created something even more extraordinary, a living museum of four worlds: music, books, art, and family.

His home was not merely a place to live; it was an experience. Every room reflected intention, beauty, culture, history, and love. Through music, literature, artwork, and storytelling, Lee created spaces that inspired thought, conversation, and connection. Lee also loved basketball and was a proud member of Omega Psi Phi Fraternity, Inc..

Family remained the center of his world.

Lee leaves to cherish his memory: his beloved wife, Philippa Carolyn Kibugu Decuir; his children, Kwame Decuir, Lisa Decuir-Hardie, and Samir Decuir; his cherished grandchildren, Jaylon and Lia; his brother, James Crockom; his sister, Mercie Booker; along with a host of nieces, nephews, extended family members, and dear friends.

He was preceded in death by his daughter, Lia Decuir; grandson, Tajuan; his father, Buker Decuir; and his mother, Elizabeth Crockom. To know Lee was to experience warmth, wisdom, culture, and quiet strength. His life reminds us that we are not simply here to exist, but to build, to love, to explore, and to leave beauty behind. Lee's legacy lives on through his family, his stories, his collections, and every life he touched.

He did not simply live a life, he created a world.

A Life

BEAUTIFULLY CURATED

LOVE, LEGACY AND FAMILY

A Love that Spanned Continents

A New Year's Eve Proposal in Kampala. At the conclusion of the historic African tour, during a New Year's Eve celebration at Kampala's famous Apollo Hotel, Lee proposed to Philippa.



A year later, they were married in Kampala, Uganda, before beginning their global journey together. Lee and Philippa later settled in Nairobi, Kenya, where he established businesses and expanded his vision for family and community.

Their children, Kwame and Lisa, were both born at Nairobi Hospital. As the family later relocated to the United States, Africa remained deeply woven into Lee's identity and family story.

A Proud Father & Grandfather

Lee's greatest joy was his family. He celebrated every milestone, offered wisdom during challenges, and loved deeply and unconditionally. His children and grandchildren will forever honor his memory with love and pride.

A Life

BEAUTIFULLY CURATED

AFRICAN JOURNEY

A continent that shaped his Purpose



A Six-Month Historic Tour (1973)

Lee was selected to participate in an official United States six-month African delegation tour alongside notable leaders, including Mr. Jim Woods.

During this extraordinary experience, he met Emperor Haile Selassie of Ethiopia, an honor he treasured throughout his life.

Lee traveled extensively across Africa collecting:

Art

Music

Cultural Knowledge

Historical Insight

"He knew Africa deeply and loved it passionately."

A Life

BEAUTIFULLY CURATED

A LIFE OF PURPOSE,
SERVICE AND IMPACT

A Legacy that Inspires Generations

LESSONS FROM A LIFE WELL LIVED

"His life was a masterclass in purpose, principle, and profound impact."

LIVE WITH PURPOSE

He lived intentionally, guided by values, vision, and a deep understanding of his calling in the world.

NEVER STOP LEARNING

A lifelong seeker of knowledge, he believed education was the key to empowerment and transformation.

SERVE WITH HUMILITY

He led with grace, listened with empathy, and uplifted others without ever seeking the spotlight.

EMBRACE CULTURE & CONNECTION

He celebrated diversity, built bridges across nations, and believed in the beauty of unity in our differences.

FAMILY IS EVERYTHING

Above all, he cherished his family. His love, guidance, and presence created memories that will last forever.

A Life

BEAUTIFULLY CURATED

GLOBAL LEADERSHIP

A remarkable life. An enduring legacy.

Lee's career was defined by vision, determination, and a deep commitment to connecting people and places across the world. From the basketball court to the boardroom, he demonstrated extraordinary leadership and earned respect on a truly global stage.

Through his travels across continents, from bustling cities to remote corners of the world, Lee developed a profound appreciation for cultures, languages, history, and humanity. His career with TWA afforded him leadership, sharpened his communication skills, and expanded his global perspective. More importantly, it nurtured a lifelong passion for connecting communities and people.

Traveling throughout Africa, Lee immersed himself in the traditions of its people, traditions, art, and music. He collected more than artifacts; he collected stories, experiences, and relationships that became woven into the fabric of his identity.

He believed in people. He invested in potential.
He built bridges. He opened doors.
He led with honor, served with humility,
and loved without limits.

His journey took him across continents,
but his impact will be felt for generations.
He leaves behind a legacy of leadership,
service, faith, and family.

We celebrate a remarkable man
whose life continues to inspire,
guide, and uplift us all.



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1940-2000
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TEL. 06/4780000000
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GUIDO RENI
VIA MONTENAPOLEONE 10, 00187 ROMA
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BACCO



GUIDO RENI
VIA DELL'INDUSTRIA, 10 - 00198 ROMA
TEL. 06/47801111 - FAX 06/47801112
BACCO



GUIDO RENI
Via Montebello 10, 00187 Roma
Tel. 06/47810111
BACCO



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GUIDO RENI
1898-1955
BACCO



GUIDO RENI
Via Mazzini 10 - 00185 Roma
Tel. 06/4780111 - 4780112
BACCO



GUIDO RENI
Via Mazzini 10 - 00185 Roma
Tel. 06/4780111 - 06/4780112
Fax 06/4780113



GUIDO RENO
VIA MONTANA 1000, 80000
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A Life

BEAUTIFULLY CURATED

LEE ARTHUR DECUIR

HUSBAND. FATHER. GRANDFATHER. LEADER. MENTOR.
FRIEND. HUMANITARIAN.



The family of Lee Arthur Decuir sincerely thanks you for your prayers,
support, love, and presence during this time of remembrance and
celebration.

Your kindness and compassion are deeply appreciated.

FOREVER REMEMBERED. NEVER FORGOTTEN
RIP "BABY RAY"

*His Legacy lives on in our hearts.
In Our Stories. In Our World.*